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Message from the CEO

Aiming to be the No. 1 Global Sports Brand

Yasuhito Hirota

Chairman and Chief Executive Officer (CEO),
Representative Director

ASICS RUN TOKYO





A Look Back on 2025

In 2025, strong growth continued, making it a year in which we felt we ascended to an even higher stage of evolution. From a financial perspective, we achieved revenue and profit growth for the fifth consecutive year. Net sales exceeded ¥800.0 billion, operating profit surpassed ¥140.0 billion, and operating margin reached 17.6%, all marking record highs. The operating margin stands at a top-class level within the industry, and we expect continued revenue and profit growth in 2026.

Rather than viewing performance on a single-year basis, I aim to steadily deliver stronger results year by year as part of our long-term growth trajectory. Looking at 2025 from this perspective, initiatives in the Performance Running category, which has long been the driving force of ASICS, progressed steadily toward achieving the No. 1 share of shoes worn at major marathons. In addition, the SportStyle and Onitsuka Tiger categories have grown into major pillars supporting overall performance. Net sales for both categories exceeded ¥100.0 billion for the first time, and their profitability remains exceptionally high, giving me strong confidence that they will drive our future growth. Onitsuka Tiger in particular has strengthened its brand presence in Europe and is beginning to establish its position as a luxury lifestyle brand that is not reliant on short-term trends.

It was also a year in which we laid the groundwork for further growth. Positioning 2025 as the “Year of JAPAN,” we leveraged events such as the World Athletics Championships Tokyo 25 to communicate the ASICS brand both within Japan and globally. We also launched METASPEED RAY, our lightest model in the shoe line, which received strong feedback such as “I didn’t know shoes could be this light,” and “They’ve changed the way I view ASICS,” providing a significant catalyst for elevating the brand.

In addition, we made further progress in expanding our running ecosystem by bringing race registration companies in Spain and Thailand into the Group and deciding to acquire business assets of multiple race registration services in the United States, steadily increasing contact points with runners worldwide.

We also received multiple external recognitions in areas such as intellectual property (IP), corporate governance, and investor relations (IR), reflecting steady progress in our corporate functions.

However, ASICS is still growing. We will continue to accelerate our progress and aim to become the No. 1 global sports brand from Japan.

Dialogue with the Capital Markets

In 2025, we began holding interactive IR briefings for individual investors. I attended sessions in Naha, Okinawa Prefecture; Sapporo, Hokkaido Prefecture; and Tokyo, where I had the opportunity to engage directly with participants. The comments that left a strong impression were, “It is thanks to ASICS shoes that I have been able to stay active at my age,” and “I hope you keep making shoes with this level of comfort.” The participant said they wanted to share this with me directly, which was an extremely rewarding moment. At the IR briefing held in March 2026, Outside Director Mitsuru Murai spoke on the intersection of sports and business, and all outside directors took part at the end of the session to offer their remarks. As a company that handles consumer goods, we aim to cultivate both loyal fans of ASICS and long-term shareholders, and we will continue to promote two-way communication going forward.

We also had numerous opportunities to engage with institutional investors, whose insights have been highly valuable in areas such as corporate governance, capital policy, and product development. I have seen an increase in direct engagement from institutional investors, and hearing comments from them about how excited they are to see our growth has been a great



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source of encouragement. We will continue to use the feedback of capital market participants as a driving force behind our further advancement.

Board Operations

Our Board of Directors conducts active discussions under a structure in which a majority of its members are outside directors with extensive experience and specialized expertise. In addition to statutory resolutions and reporting matters, the Board designates key matters for discussion related to the future growth of the ASICS Group. Outside directors provide frank opinions and proposals, which are promptly and carefully reflected in management, with the outcomes reported at the following month’s Board meeting. We recognize that the supervision of business execution, led by independent outside directors, is functioning effectively.

Furthermore, following approval at the Ordinary General Meeting of Shareholders held in March 2026, Jenifer Rogers was appointed as our first non-Japanese director. With Ms. Rogers bringing a global perspective on corporate management, specialized legal expertise, and extensive experience in the financial sector, her appointment will further strengthen the Board’s oversight function and effectiveness while promoting transparent management.

The ASICS Foundation

In April 2025, we established the ASICS Foundation, a general incorporated foundation. The Company established the foundation based on the belief that contributing to the mental and physical well-being of more people by addressing social issues related to exercise and sports is a core part of its mission. Under independent operation, in its first year, the foundation is providing grants to six organizations across four countries—Japan, India, Indonesia, and Cambodia—to support their activities for up to three years. While ASICS will continue to pursue growth with a focus on profitability as a business entity, the foundation will take on the role of contributing to individuals facing social and economic challenges.

Challenges for Enhancing Corporate Value

To date, we have improved profitability through a focus on selection and concentration. While continuing to pursue this high level of profitability and high-quality growth, we believe it is now necessary to expand profit levels going forward. There remain several challenges to address in achieving this.

First is the securing of talent to support future growth and innovation. Under the leadership of COO Mitsuyuki Tominaga, diversity of talent has increased significantly as part of the transformation to a Global Integrated Enterprise. For example, the head of ASICS India Private Limited has been appointed as an executive officer at headquarters, and the head of marketing in ASICS Europe B.V. has assumed the role of senior general manager at headquarters. These developments represent major changes, enabling the global deployment of best practices from individual regions and enhancing overall optimization while also fostering shared understanding of management and corporate strategy between headquarters and regional operating companies. They also create opportunities for the development and advancement of next-generation management talent.

Second is continuous innovation. To this end, we are strengthening investments in research facilities and manufacturing. In addition to its existing research base in Japan, new research hubs have been established in Europe and the United States, alongside partnerships with universities and research institutions. The Company is also advancing initiatives such as the opening of the Onitsuka Innovative Factory in Tottori Prefecture and the establishment of the ASICS TECHNICAL LAB, a manufacturing facility located in Hyogo Prefecture for top athletes. IP strategy is also critical. By involving the IP function from the product development stage, we will ensure that the outcomes of innovation are firmly linked to brand value.

As we enter the next stage of accelerated growth, the Company is addressing these challenges head-on, as outlined in this integrated report. We look forward to your continued expectations as ASICS strives to become the No. 1 global sports brand.



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